

Prediction Is Not Fact

Project: Helpful Classroom Sorter

1. Your mission

Your learning target

I can separate a recorded prediction from the observation used to check it.

I can compare matching cases using a stated outcome rule and preserve unresolved evidence.

I can report checked results without counting missing observations as successes or failures.

Remember before reading

Close your notes first. A rough first answer helps us choose the right starting point; it is not a score for your ability.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Boundaries and 'Not Sure'. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Build a Human Classifier. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Repeating Efficiently. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

After trying, check the relevant lesson or ask your teacher. Change the part of your explanation that the evidence shows was wrong.

A prediction is a fallible output supported by clues.



LEARNING TARGET On Monday a team predicts 'rain on Tuesday'. On Tuesday they count a damp playground as success, although sprinklers ran. Write an observation rule that could have been agreed before Tuesday.

Learner name:

Readiness for the connected explanation

A model predicts far, but the distance record is unreadable. Can this case be called correct? What evidence would let you check it?

This week's end goal

By the end, I can keep predicted and observed outcomes separate and audit a disagreement.

2. Notice the evidence

PICTURE STORY

Look Closely Before You Explain

Pictures give clues; evidence tells us what the clues mean.



MYSTERY A rain prediction uses weather clues, but the later observation of rain or no rain is the fact that evaluates it.

What do you notice?

Name three visible details without explaining them yet.

Circle the detail most connected to the system's decision.

Name one detail that may be decoration or distraction.

Make a first prediction and state the clue that supports it.

My observations, prediction, and evidence:

GOOD THINKING A prediction can change when stronger evidence appears.

A closer explanation

A prediction states what a model outputs. An observation records what was measured or happened. To check a prediction, keep both records and compare the same case under the same outcome rule. Writing a prediction into the observation column would make the check circular.

Use a fictional ramp investigation. Before each trial, Ramp1 predicts far for a ramp height of at least 6 cm and near otherwise. Its allowed heights are whole centimetres from 1 through 10. After a toy rolls, a learner measures its travel distance. The outcome rule is far for a distance of at least 4 floor units and near otherwise. Ramp height and travel distance are different quantities.

The values in this lesson are invented practice records, not a physical law about ramps. Ramp1 is a fixed paper model for learning how to check predictions. Each trial has an ID so that its height, prediction and

later measurement stay together. Keep the model version and record the prediction before opening the observation card.

3. See how it works

VISUAL MECHANISM

Input → **Process** → **Output**

Follow the information instead of imagining magic inside the machine.



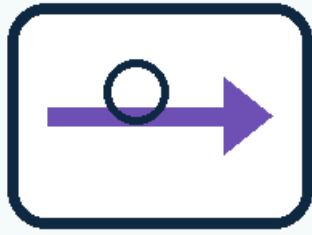
INPUT

available evidence



PROCESS

use a rule or model to estimate an unseen outcome



OUTPUT

prediction that must remain separate from
verified fact

INPUT available evidence

PROCESS use a rule or model to estimate an unseen outcome

OUTPUT prediction that must remain separate from verified fact

CORE IDEA A prediction is a fallible output supported by clues.

UNDER THE HOOD Prediction estimates a target that is unknown at decision time. Evidence supports the estimate; ground truth is the later or independently established outcome. Treating predictions as labels can create self-confirming records.

Draw a fresh example with all three stages:

A closer explanation

Two records meet at a comparison

Before the trial · After the trial · Comparison

Before the trial: A: height 4 cm

After the trial: Distance 3 units

Comparison: Near matches near

Before the trial: B: height 6 cm

After the trial: Distance 3 units

Comparison: Far differs from near

Before the trial: C: height 8 cm

After the trial: Distance 5 units

Comparison: Far matches far

Ramp1 predicts from height: A near, B far, C far. The observation is travel distance. Apply the distance outcome rule separately, then compare categories for the same trial.

For B, the input 6 cm produces the prediction far. The later distance of 3 units produces the observed category near. This is a mismatch. Retain far as the original prediction and near as the observed category. Changing the old prediction to near would hide the mistake rather than improve the original result.

For A and C, the categories match. These two matches provide evidence about these trials. They do not show that every future prediction will be correct. Even a correctly computed prediction can disagree with an observation because following the model rule and matching the world are different checks.

Connect the picture and the explanation

Point to the input, the deciding step and the result in this week's visual. Explain the same step in ordinary words. A picture helps when you can say what each part represents.

4. Compare the cases

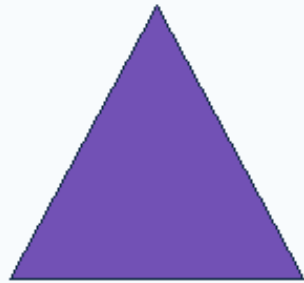
PICTURE GALLERY

Four Cases, Four Clues

Use the visual cue, then read the evidence carefully.



Rain may start



Dark clouds



Rain gauge recorded water



Animal label from model

CASE 1 — Rain may start Clue: forecast output. Meaning: prediction.

CASE 2 — Dark clouds Clue: observed condition. Meaning: evidence.

CASE 3 — Rain gauge recorded water Clue: later measurement. Meaning: fact for evaluation.

CASE 4 — Animal label from model Clue: unverified output. Meaning: prediction, not fact.

BOUNDARY Do not copy a model prediction into the answer column and later call it ground truth.

Which two pictures are easiest to confuse? What evidence separates them?

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Keep score 4 but measure exactly 8 minutes.

Prediction: The observed label becomes quick and agrees with the prediction.

Reason: Above 8 is strict: equality is quick under this policy.

5. Words that unlock the idea

VOCABULARY

Words You Can See and Use

The badge is a memory cue; the definition does the real thinking work.





evidence



fact



Word · Meaning · My example

Word: prediction

Meaning: estimate about an unknown outcome

My example: _____

Word: evidence

Meaning: information that supports or challenges a claim

My example: _____

Word: fact

Meaning: claim established by direct or reliable checking

My example: _____

Word: ground truth

Meaning: reference outcome used to evaluate a prediction

My example: _____

Misconception detective

CLAIM TO REPAIR A confident prediction is a fact.

Use one vocabulary word and one piece of evidence to repair it:

WORD POWER A strong definition helps you decide something in a new case.

Words used in the closer explanation

Word · Meaning

Word: Observation

Meaning: A recorded measurement or event used as evidence

Word: Outcome rule

Meaning: The agreed method for turning observed evidence into the category being checked

Word: Mismatch

Meaning: A prediction that differs from an established comparison outcome

Word: Unassessed

Meaning: A case whose prediction has not yet been judged against adequate outcome evidence

6. Follow a worked example

WORKED EXAMPLE

Watch the Reasoning, Not Just the Answer

Every step connects a claim to observable evidence.



CASE A rain prediction uses weather clues, but the later observation of rain or no rain is the fact that evaluates it.

STEP 1 — OBSERVE available evidence

STEP 2 — TRACE use a rule or model to estimate an unseen outcome

STEP 3 — CONCLUDE prediction that must remain separate from verified fact

MODEL REASONING Mark model or rule outputs as predictions, observable clues as evidence, and independently checked outcomes as facts. A prediction becomes evaluated against a fact; it does not become a fact merely because time passes.

DO NOT OVERCLAIM Do not copy a model prediction into the answer column and later call it ground truth.

What new evidence could change this answer?

A closer explanation

Record · Evidence available · Status under the outcome rule

Record: D: height 5 cm; predicts near

Evidence available: Distance missing

Status under the outcome rule: Unassessed; request the trial record

Record: E: height 7 cm; predicts far

Evidence available: Two records say 3 and 4 units

Status under the outcome rule: Unassessed; investigate the conflict

Record: F: height 6 cm; predicts far

Evidence available: Verified distance exactly 4 units

Status under the outcome rule: Match; at least 4 includes 4

For E, 3 units means near and 4 units means far. The disagreement can change the judgment. Check the trial ID, original measurement and recording procedure. Do not choose the distance that makes Ramp1 look better. If the conflict cannot be resolved, retain both reports and mark the comparison unassessed.

An observation is evidence, not an automatic guarantee of truth. A wrong trial ID, unclear unit or copying error can make the comparison unreliable. If a supported correction is made, retain the original entry, the correction, its source and the reason. Remeasuring a new trial does not reveal what happened in the old one.

Learn from the worked case

Cover the result before checking it. Say what is given, choose the procedure, and follow one step at a time. Then uncover the result and explain your first mismatch. Ask why a step is allowed, not only what number it produces.

A pictorial worked case: Prediction Is Not Fact

A fictional drying trial uses a fixed rule and later measures what actually happened.

The facts we will use

Model D predicts slow when moisture score is at least 5; quick otherwise.

Observation policy: slow if drying takes above 8 minutes; quick otherwise. Trial T has score 4 and measured time 9 minutes.

Prediction Is Not Fact

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Prediction input

T has moisture score 4.



2. Predict

4 is below 5, so D predicts quick.



3. Observe later

Measured time is 9 minutes; above 8 means observed slow.



4. Compare evidence

Prediction quick disagrees with observation slow.

CHANGE ONE THING

Keep score 4 but measure exactly 8 minutes.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Prediction input

What happens and why: T has moisture score 4.

Step: 2. Predict

What happens and why: 4 is below 5, so D predicts quick.

Step: 3. Observe later

What happens and why: Measured time is 9 minutes; above 8 means observed slow.

Step: 4. Compare evidence

What happens and why: Prediction quick disagrees with observation slow.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

The moisture score generates a prediction; it is not the observed drying time. The later measurement supplies separate evidence under the stated observation policy. Save both values and their units. Altering the recorded time to match D would destroy the evaluation rather than repair the model.

What this example does not establish

One failure does not prove every prediction is wrong; one agreement does not establish reliability on future trials.

7. Find and repair a mistake

COMPARE

Same Result, Different Reason

A comparison helps reveal the true concept boundary.

Case · Evidence · What it shows

Case: Rain may start

Evidence: forecast output

What it shows: prediction

Case: Dark clouds

Evidence: observed condition

What it shows: evidence

Case: Rain gauge recorded water

Evidence: later measurement

What it shows: fact for evaluation

Case: Animal label from model

Evidence: unverified output

What it shows: prediction, not fact

Repair two tempting claims

CLAIM A A confident prediction is a fact.

Repair:

CLAIM B Evidence and prediction are two words for the same thing.

Repair:

STRONG ANSWER FRAME I claim _____ because the evidence shows _____. The process is _____. One limit is _____.

A closer explanation

Start a mismatch investigation by checking the input, trial ID, prediction calculation and observation procedure. A mismatch alone does not identify which part caused the problem. If all records are sound, this case is evidence that the model prediction did not match the outcome.

If you revise the model after seeing B, record a new version. A new prediction for B can help explain the change, but it is no longer a check on an unseen case. Preserve Ramp1's result and use new reserved trials to evaluate the revised version, following Week 15's method.

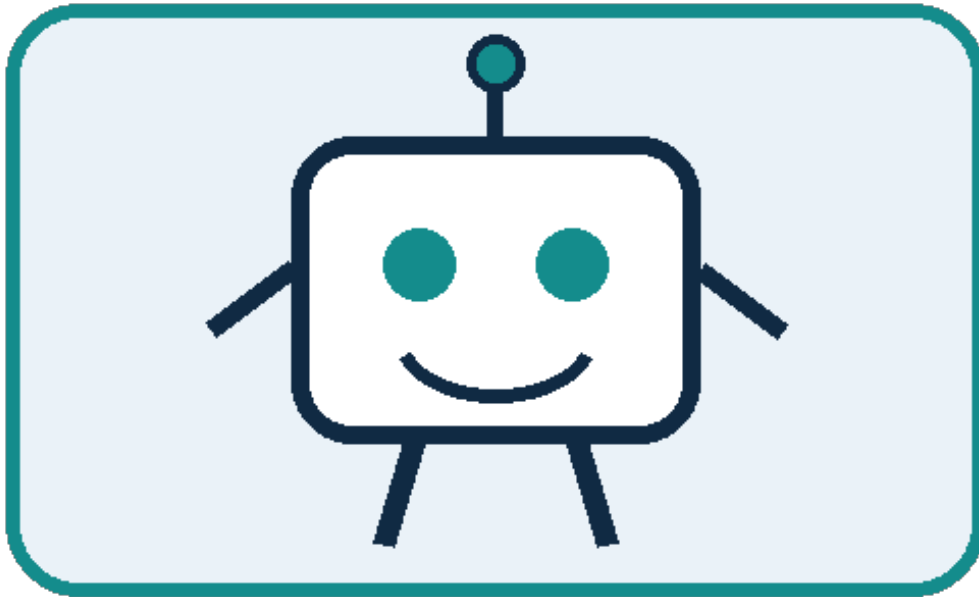
A learner changes B's old prediction from far to near after reading its distance, then reports three matches out of three. Explain what is wrong with the report and how to preserve an honest record

8. Practise together

GUIDED PRACTICE

Try It, Check It, Explain It

Use support now so you can succeed independently later.



Explain how the picture story demonstrates this idea: A prediction is a fallible output supported by clues.

Use a fresh example to explain prediction.

Trace a new input → process → output example.

Find and repair the error in: Evidence and prediction are two words for the same thing.

Invent one edge case and name the safe response.

PARTNER CHECK Point to the evidence. Do not accept an answer that only repeats the vocabulary word.

A closer explanation

Consider only trials A through E. Three have established outcomes: A, B and C. Two of those three predictions match and one does not. D and E are unassessed. Report two matches out of three assessed trials, with two more trials unassessed. Do not report four successes by treating the unknowns as correct, or two out of five as if every trial had a known outcome.

Write a results record for A through E. Include each prediction, its observed category or unresolved evidence, its comparison status, and a summary that names both assessed and unassessed counts. Explain why D and E cannot be counted as correct

The missing cases might be different from the checked cases. The result describes the assessed group; it does not settle performance on all five or on future trials. Collect the missing evidence where possible, document what remains unknown, and keep the original model version visible. Week 23 will develop performance fractions more fully.

Practise with less help: Check a boundary without changing the rule

Use workbook W2 for the connected example “Predictions and observations”. First fill the input and rule boxes. Try the middle steps before asking for a hint. After a hint, try the next step yourself.

Plan · Do · Check

Plan: What is given? Which rule or procedure applies?

Do: Record each intermediate step.

Check: Does the result follow? What remains unknown?

Explain your trace to a partner. Your partner points to one step to check. Swap roles on the next case. Each person writes their own explanation.

Check your reasoning

Use the worked case for Predictions and observations. Proposed explanation: “Running the rule correctly proves the prediction correct”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Answer on your own before discussion. If you are unsure, say which step you need help with.

Explain the picture

Which field changes the observation label, and which field changes the model prediction?

My explanation using a pictured step and the given facts

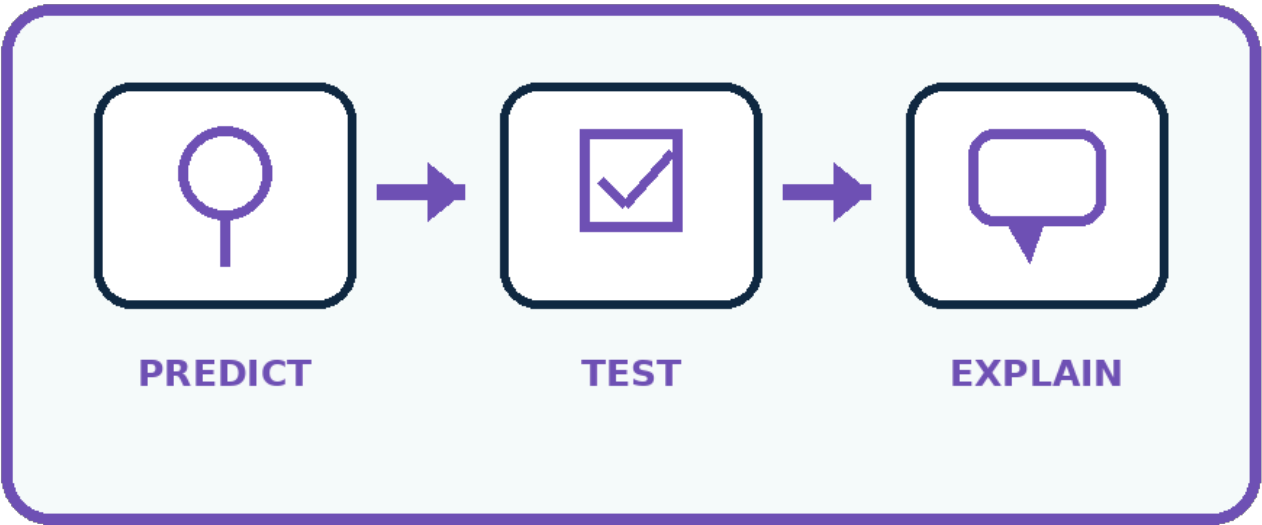
This is supported practice. Keep the separately named independent case for an attempt before feedback.

9. Run the investigation

EXPLORER LAB

Prediction-Evidence-Fact Sort

Predict first, test honestly, and explain what the evidence means.



State your prediction before the result is known.

Complete the task: Separate prediction, evidence, and fact in four scenarios.

Keep a normal case and an edge case clearly separated.

Record what happened—even when it does not match your prediction.

Explain the result, one limitation, and the next useful test.

Case · Prediction · Observed result · What it means

Case: Normal

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

Case: Edge

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

INDEPENDENCE After support is removed, repeat the proof with a fresh case.

Plan → try → check

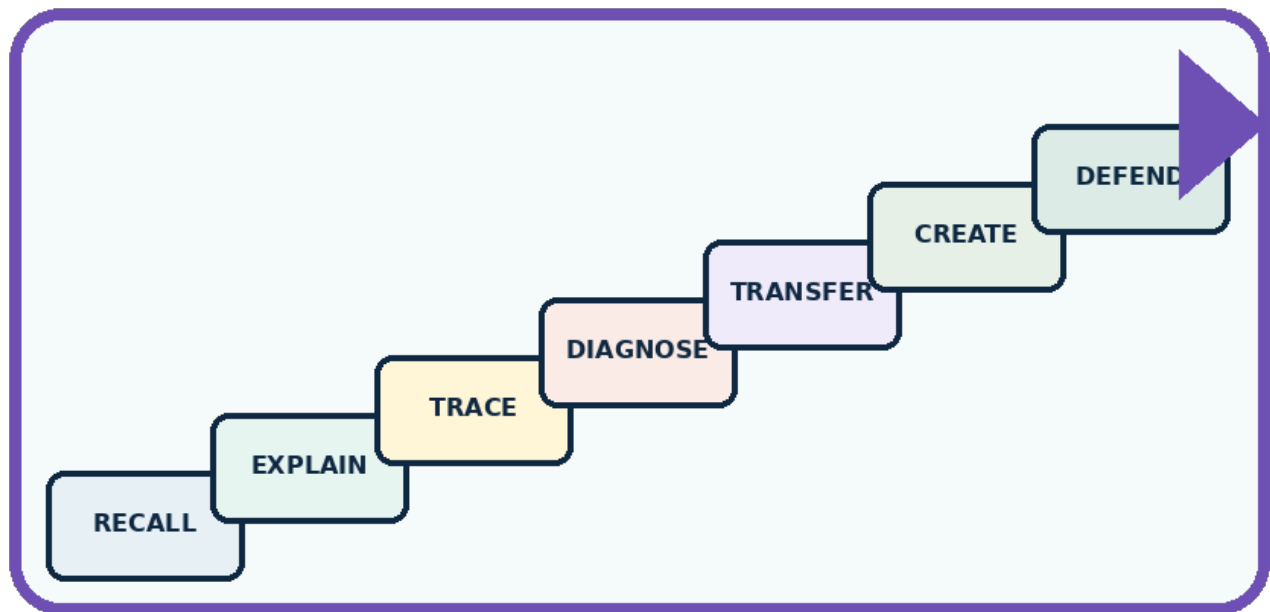
Before trying: what do I expect, and why? While trying: which step could first go wrong? Afterwards: what did I actually observe, and what should change? Keep “not run” if you only traced the procedure.

10. Build your understanding

PRACTICE LADDER

Climb from Recall to Defense

Each step asks for a stronger kind of understanding.



RECALL Define prediction.

EXPLAIN A prediction is a fallible output supported by clues.

TRACE Show the input, process, and output.

DIAGNOSE Repair: A confident prediction is a fact.

TRANSFER Apply the idea to a new home or classroom case.

CREATE Design one revealing test.

DEFEND Give a claim, evidence, mechanism, limit, and safe action.

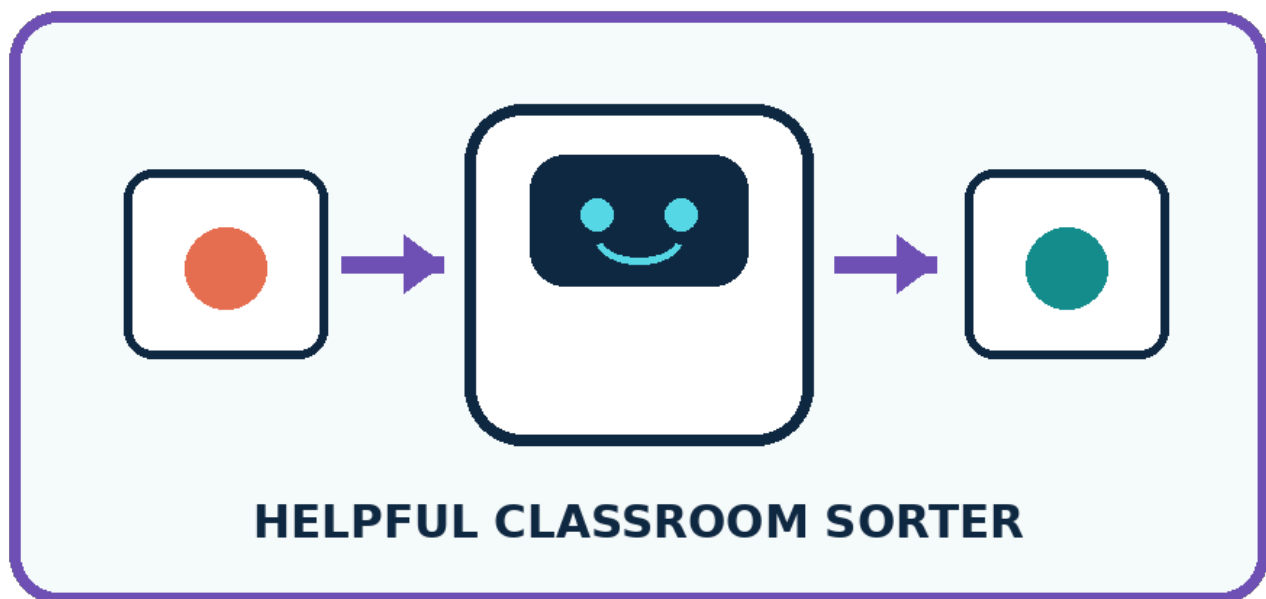
RETRY RULE A coached answer becomes mastery only after you solve a different case independently.

11. Connect your project

PROJECT

Helpful Classroom Sorter

Build one coherent system across the year, one evidence-based decision at a time.



THIS WEEK'S CHECKPOINT Label the sorter's suggested bin as a prediction until a human confirms the final placement.

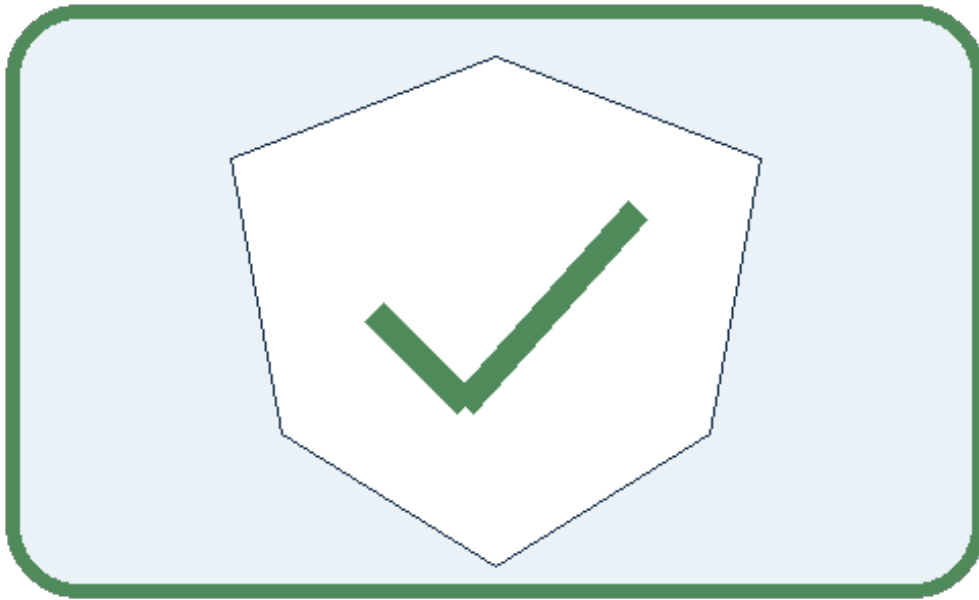
What real classroom need does this serve?

What information is necessary—and what should stay private?

What happens inside the process?

What normal and edge cases will you test?

When should it say not sure or ask a person?



RESPONSIBLE DESIGN Do not copy a model prediction into the answer column and later call it ground truth.

My project decision:

Evidence for your project

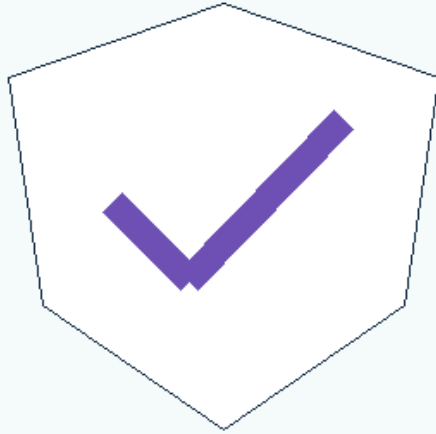
In sorter trials, record predicted categories before collecting reference evidence, then retain disagreements for investigation.

12. Show what you know

MASTERY

Fresh-Case Independent Proof

Complete this after teaching and guided practice have ended.



INDEPENDENT PROOF

REQUIRED PROOF Separate prediction, evidence, and fact in four scenarios and explain how one prediction could later be checked.

- ☐ Name or draw the fresh case.
- ☐ Trace input, process, and output.
- ☐ State the conclusion and strongest evidence.
- ☐ Name one limit, failure, missing clue, or fairness/privacy concern.
- ☐ Explain one safe next action or improvement.

Independent evidence:

SELF-CHECK Mark model or rule outputs as predictions, observable clues as evidence, and independently checked outcomes as facts. A prediction becomes evaluated against a fact; it does not become a fact merely because time passes.

My level: ☐ Not yet ☐ With one hint ☐ Independently ☐ I can teach it

NEXT BRIDGE Carry today's evidence habit into: Confidence Is Not Correctness.

13. Study a complete case

Week 17 Worked case

Use the supplied details to practise the weekly concept before attempting the independent question. This

case extends the illustrated lesson.

The situation

A weather helper predicts tomorrow's rain.

The question

Is this a fact about tomorrow? How can it be checked?

Worked explanation

It is a prediction. Record it now and compare with a predefined rain observation tomorrow. Useful predictions are not guarantees.

Explain it in your own words

Which detail supports the answer, and why does it matter?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Trace the supplied case visually

A prediction becomes checkable evidence

Evidence or stage · Value or result

Evidence or stage: Today

Value or result: Record tomorrow's rain prediction

Evidence or stage: Tomorrow

Value or result: Observe using an agreed rain rule

Evidence or stage: Compare

Value or result: Prediction versus observation

A weather helper predicts tomorrow's rain.

Is this a fact about tomorrow? How can it be checked?

It is a prediction. Record it now and compare with a predefined rain observation tomorrow. Useful predictions are not guarantees.

14. Try a new case independently

Independent case: Transfer the check to drying predictions

In a fictional paper test, Dry1 predicts slow for a moisture score of at least 7, quick otherwise. Allowed scores are whole numbers 1 through 10. The observed outcome is slow if drying time is greater than 10 minutes, quick otherwise. Records are P: score 6, time 12; Q: score 7, time 10; R: score 9, time 14; S: score 5, time missing. Record all predictions, observed categories and comparison statuses. Summarise matches out of assessed cases, name the unassessed count, and limit the conclusion.

My independent explanation, trace and limits

Attempt this case before feedback. Record any help. Earlier examples below are further practice; a case already practised with feedback cannot establish fresh transfer.

Week 17 Independent application

Close the worked explanation. Apply the idea to this different question without copying.

A model predicts rain tomorrow. Tomorrow is dry. Was the prediction an observation of tomorrow? Explain what new evidence settles the result.

My answer, with a trace, calculation or supporting evidence

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Create and test

Change one relevant detail. Predict the result before testing. Include a boundary or missing-information case when it helps reveal a limit.

My changed input and expected result

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Connect to your project

Label the sorter's suggested bin as a prediction until a human confirms the final placement.

The evidence I will keep

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Your teacher has the independent answer and scoring criteria. Complete the matching workbook week to keep your practice evidence together.

Transfer practice from the original programme

On Monday a team predicts 'rain on Tuesday'. On Tuesday they count a damp playground as success, although sprinklers ran. Write an observation rule that could have been agreed before Tuesday.

Explain the mechanism, evidence and one limit.

Use feedback to improve

Attempt the independent case before hints. Record whether you worked alone, used a hint or followed a model. After feedback, fix the first unsupported step and explain why it changed. A later check uses a changed case, not a copied answer.